



2.03 Working with Tire Chains

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Standard Operating Procedure is to identify the hazards and define the steps in the installation , monitoring and removal of Tire chains .

2. Scope

This procedure is intended for use for all Silverpoint employees .

3. Hazard Assessment & Identification

- Physical Stress
- Ergonomics
- Physical Injury
- Slips , Trips , Falls
- Lifting , Bending , Twisting
- Pinch Points , Sharp Objects
- Temperature Extremes
- Equipment Failure
- Potential Stored Energy
- Personal Injury

4. EHS Requirements

- Fire Retardant Coveralls
- CSA Approved Boots
- Safety Glasses
- Gloves
- Hardhat
- Follow Lock-out Procedure

5. References

- Silverpoint Corporate Codes of Practice



- Alberta OH&S
- Kinedyne Canada Limited Tire Chain Instructions
- Silverpoint Task List
- Silverpoint THA 2.03

6. Procedure

6.1. Park the truck safely on a level well lit work area .

6.1.1. Engage Park brake and chock the wheels , complete a walk-around , look for hazards .

6.1.2. Determine what kind of tire chains to use, i.e., singles , triples or steering .

6.2. Using proper lifting techniques , remove tire chains from rack .

6.2.1. Slide out tire chain rack if so equipped , Lift one tire chain at a time from rack .

6.3. Spread tire chain out neatly on the ground **WITH STUDS UP** and cams furthest from the truck . If tire chains have no cams , the boomer should be on the outside . This will orientate the tire chain ready for installation . Slide back the tire chain rack and lock into position .

6.4. Inspect the tire chains for damage . I.e., broken or missing rails , worn out chain , broken or missing parts , stretched or in disrepair .

6.5. When using singles , pick up the tire chain from the center of the inside rail (Rail without cams) and drape over the tire . Ensure chain is straight and free of snags or twisted bars .

6.5.1. Drive onto tire chain (approx .1/4 turn of tire) and then pull up tire chain up around tire . **ENSURE STUDS ARE UP.**

6.5.2. Pull up slack to shorten the rails as much as possible .

6.5.3. Join ends on both sides of tire chain ensuring rails are not twisted **inside rail first.**

6.5.4. Insert T handled cam tensioning tool into slot in the cam .

6.5.5. Tire chain must be snug with minimal slack after tensioning .

6.5.6. When tensioned , each cam will be in position with curved slot towards center of wheel .

6.5.7. Turn all tensioning cams clockwise to tighten the side rails .

6.5.8. If tire chains are loose , undo cams , pull out excess slack and re-hook ends to shorten side rails , Re-tension the cams .

6.5.9. It is advised to recheck tension /fit during operation and tighten as necessary .

6.6. If you are using triples , pick up the inside rail and fold it over itself . Pick up the tire chain from the center of the center rail and drape over the top of the outside tire , then unfold over the inside tire . Ensure tire chain is straight and free of snags **WITH STUDS UP.**



- 6.6.1. Pull rails tight and connect **center rail first**.
- 6.6.2. Tie up loose end.
- 6.6.3. Pull rails tight and connect inside rail. Tie up loose end.
- 6.6.4. Pull outside rail tight and lock in place, tying up loose end.
- 6.6.5. Treat steering chains as singles.
- 6.7. Using the cam tool, tighten up the cams. There should be no loose ends flailing around breaking the TPC lines or damaging the truck.
- 6.8. Remove tire chocks and drive a maximum of 1 kilometer at a slow speed, stay in low range. Get out of the truck and retighten all tire chains on a suitable surface. Starting with loosening cams, then pull up slack and re-tighten.
- 6.9. Now the tire chains are installed. **DO NOT EXCEED 50 KILOMETERS PER HOUR** while driving with chains on, as damage will occur. I.e., TPC lines torn off, brake pot air line torn off, damage to other tires, fender damage.
- 6.10. **Monitor the tire chains at all times** and tighten as necessary. Call before new chains are needed.
- 6.11. To remove the tire chains, safely park the truck on a level well lit work area.
 - 6.11.1. Engage the park brake and chock the tire and complete a walk-around and look for hazards.
- 6.12. Move truck until hooks are on top of the tire. With the tire chain cam tool loosen all the cams.
 - 6.12.1. With the tire chain hooks to the top of the tire, unhook the tire chains outside rail first, then the center rail, finally unhook the inside rail.
 - 6.12.2. Pull as much of the tire chains out and away from the tire as you can in an orderly fashion.
- 6.13. Remove the tire chocks from the tire and safely drive off of the tire chains careful not to snag the tire chains.
- 6.14. Inspect tire chains before hanging. Put the tire chains back on the tire chain rack. If so equipped, slide out tire chain rack and neatly and tightly put the tire chains back on the rack using proper lifting techniques.
 - 6.14.1. Push back and lock the tire chain rack into place.
 - 6.14.2. If tire chains are damaged, mark it in the PMI, and repair or replace tire chains ASAP.

Remember : if you are in doubt about what to do, call your supervisor